

Rice (Cereal Crop) in Madhya Pradesh

1. Introduction

- Rice is an important Kharif crop in Madhya Pradesh.
 - It is mostly grown in areas with good water availability like eastern MP.
 - It provides food security and livelihood to many farmers in the state.
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2. Major Rice-Producing Districts

- **Eastern MP:** Jabalpur, Rewa, Mandla, Balaghat, Shahdol
 - **Other regions:** Some rice is also grown in Hoshangabad, Seoni, and Sidhi
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3. Soil and Climate Requirements

- **Soil:** Clayey loam or alluvial soils are ideal; moisture-retentive soils preferred
 - **Climate:**
 - Rainfall: 100–150 cm during Kharif
 - Temperature: 25–35°C during growth period
 - **Water:** Needs continuous water for proper growth
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4. Varieties Grown in MP

- **Swarna** – high-yielding variety, widely cultivated
 - **MTU-1010** – medium-duration variety
 - **PR-106** – short-duration variety
 - **Local traditional varieties** – grown in tribal and forest areas
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5. Cultivation Practices in MP

1. **Land Preparation:** Ploughing and puddling of fields
2. **Sowing/Transplanting:**
 - Nursery sowing in June–July
 - Transplantation after 25–30 days
3. **Irrigation:** Required in low-rainfall areas; otherwise rainfed
4. **Fertilization:** Nitrogen, phosphorus, potassium based on soil test
5. **Weed Control:** Manual or chemical
6. **Pest & Disease Management:** Blast, stem borer, leaf folder

6. Growth Stages

- Similar to general rice cultivation: germination → vegetative → reproductive → ripening
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7. Harvesting in MP

- **Harvesting Time:** Sept–Oct
 - **Method:** Manual harvesting is common; threshing to separate grains
 - **Yield:** 2.5–4 tons/ha (HYV varieties)
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8. Uses

- Food: Main staple in MP households
 - Industrial: Rice bran oil, rice flour
 - Animal feed: Broken rice and husk
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9. Advantages of Rice Cultivation in MP

- Suits eastern MP with good water availability
 - Provides employment and livelihood to tribal farmers
 - Can be intercropped with pulses in some areas
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10. Challenges

- Waterlogging in lowlands during heavy rains
- Low yield in rainfed upland areas
- Pests and diseases reduce productivity